



THE GOLDEN-CROWNED KINGLET is one of many small insect eaters that feed and nest high above the ground.

CANOPY



OWLS, such as this great horned owl, fly at night, hunting the many small mammals and birds that live in temperate rain forest.



THE NORTH AMERICAN PORCUPINE is a slow and awkward tree climber, but it manages to reach the tree tops to eat buds and bark.

UNDERSTORY



THE FISHER belies its name in that it rarely catches fish. It is one of the few animals that includes porcupines among its prey.



THE STOAT'S slim body enables it to pursue animals into their burrows, leaving them little chance of escape.

GROUND



SLUGS in temperate rain forest include plant-eating species and some that prey on other slugs.

Temperate rain forest

The world's largest areas of rain forest are found in the tropics, but rain forest also exists in parts of the temperate world. It grows where west-facing mountains intercept moist air blowing in from the sea and, unlike boreal forest, it experiences relatively mild temperatures all year round.

Compared with boreal forest, temperate rain forest is a rare habitat, occurring in a few widely separated areas. In the Southern Hemisphere, it is found in the

South Island of New Zealand, and in parts of southern Chile. In

both of these places, most rain forest trees are broad-leaved species, but in America's Pacific northwest—where the largest temperate rain forest in the world can be found—the trees are almost entirely conifers. Some are over nearly 250 ft (75 m) high, and more than 500 years old.

This kind of coniferous forest looks unlike any other. On the ground, and in the understory, every surface is draped with ferns or waterlogged moss. Densely packed trunks, some over 9¾ ft (3 m) across, rise up to the canopy high overhead, where the sky is always laden with rain.

Temperate rain forest supports many animals that are found in coniferous forest all over the world, but it has some additional features that set it apart: the mild, damp conditions, which make it a haven for slugs and salamanders, and the immense amount of fallen lumber, which creates opportunities for insects that feed on dead wood. In its natural state, the forest teems with mammals, as well as with owls and other birds that need large, old trees as nest sites. Unfortunately, these trees are in great demand by the lumber industry and, as a result, untouched temperate rain forest is increasingly rare.



TEMPERATE RAIN FOREST is found on west-facing coasts, where heavy rain falls throughout much of the year.

HABITATS

CLEAR CUTTING

Conifers are essential in lumber production and paper making, but harvesting them has far-reaching effects on wildlife. Many animals—particularly hole-nesting birds—rely on old trees, and are rare in planted forests that are routinely clear cut. On the other hand, where smaller blocks are cut at different times, clear cutting can be used to create a

patchwork of forest habitats. This helps forest animals, although plantations are still no match for original or "old-growth" forest, which has never been felled.



COMPLETE CLEARANCE

Total clear cutting removes all the trees in large areas of forest, forcing the animal inhabitants to move out.